



▲ The Dial screen, with call history



▲ Add a new contact



▲ The Facebook App



Figure 3: 5 megapixel camera - without flash



Figure 4: Volume rocker is intelligently fused in the phone's design

links written in minute fonts and spaced too close together.

The dedicated search button mostly brings out Google Search. However, in some apps, it launches HTC's inherent search box. At the top, there is a 3.5 mm jack for audio, and a slot to open the battery cover. The bottom exhibits HTC's trademark ExtUSB socket, for charging and data transfer, along with the microphone. The volume rocker is to the left of the phone. It is very slim and mounted flush with the casing. One good thing is that like the WinMo devices, the volume rocker can be used even when the phone's locked. This is useful since it enables you to change the volume level without having to take it out of your jacket pocket, for instance. However, since the rocker is at the same level with the case, it does become tough to locate, at times.

Sadly, Hero has no dedicated camera button. The camera needs to be accessed from an internal menu and the trackball doubles up as the shutter button. There is also a separate zoom menu. However, you are advised not to use it since it is only a digital



Figure 5: The SD card slot is inside the battery cover



Figure 6: Pretty powerful speaker - with the LED zoom and can be achieved using any photo editing software.

There are no slots or buttons on the right.

Display

The display of Hero is a 3.2-inch capacitive TFT screen (68x45mm) with 480 x 320 pixel resolution (HVGA). The screen uses a new oleophobic treatment (similar to the iPhone 3GS), to make it more touch sensitive and smudge resistant. Unfortunately, the screen is a finger print magnet and you will find yourself rubbing it with your handkerchief pretty often.

The screen has a wide viewing angle, with hardly any distortion. While the colours are very bright, it gets washed out under direct sunlight. It is also very responsive to touch, although still a bit behind the legendary iPhone. However, we must keep in mind that Android is typically designed for resistive displays that are more suited to a stylus. Yet, the OS has come a long way in the world of finger-touch.

Camera

This monster has a 5 mega-pixel camera with auto-focus. It is placed at the top part of the rear side. While the photo shots are really great in